

Module Handbook – B.A. International Business

Stand: 1. September 2025

Under Section 9 (3) of the General Examination Regulations this Module Handbook is binding with respect to the following fields: Module content, Form of assessment, Requirements for the award of credit points. Binding fields are marked [binding] below. All other entries are descriptive.

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Semester 1

This section contains 5 module descriptions.

IB-1-001 Principles of Business Administration

Semester	1	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- describe the principal functions of a commercial enterprise and their interdependence
- distinguish legal forms of enterprise and their consequences for liability and finance
- apply basic decision models to operational business problems

Module content [binding]

- The enterprise as an economic and legal unit
- Legal forms and governance structures
- Functional areas: procurement, production, marketing, finance
- Organisational structures and coordination mechanisms
- Decision theory: objectives, alternatives, criteria
- Introduction to corporate governance and stakeholder analysis

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with case-based tutorial (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-120 — Written examination, 120 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-120).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Wöhe, Döring: Einführung in die Allgemeine Betriebswirtschaftslehre, Vahlen
- Schierenbeck, Wöhle: Grundzüge der Betriebswirtschaftslehre, De Gruyter

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Foundation for IB-4-016.

Module description IB-1-001 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-1-002 Financial Accounting

Semester	1	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- record business transactions in double-entry form
- prepare and read a balance sheet and income statement
- explain the differences between German commercial law accounting and international standards

Module content [binding]

- Inventory, balance sheet, double-entry bookkeeping
- Recording of purchases, sales, payroll and taxes
- Depreciation and valuation principles
- Year-end closing entries
- Structure of financial statements
- Comparison of HGB and IFRS principles

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with exercise (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-120 — Written examination, 120 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-120).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Coenenberg, Haller, Schultze: Jahresabschluss und Jahresabschlussanalyse, Schäffer-Poeschel

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Foundation for IB-2-006 and IB-3-014.

Module description IB-1-002 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-1-003 Business Mathematics and Statistics

Semester	1	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: Secondary school mathematics

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- apply financial mathematics to interest, annuity and amortisation problems
- summarise and present empirical business data
- conduct and interpret elementary statistical tests

Module content [binding]

- Sequences, series, interest and annuity calculations
- Functions and marginal analysis in economic applications
- Descriptive statistics: location, dispersion, concentration
- Probability and common distributions
- Estimation and hypothesis testing
- Correlation and simple regression

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with tutorial (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-90 — Written examination, 90 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-90).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Tietze: Einführung in die Finanzmathematik, Springer Spektrum
- Newbold, Carlson, Thorne: Statistics for Business and Economics, Pearson

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Foundation for IB-2-009.

Module description IB-1-003 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-1-004 Introduction to Economics

Semester	1	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- analyse market outcomes using supply and demand models
- explain the effects of market failure and public intervention
- interpret macroeconomic indicators and policy measures

Module content [binding]

- Scarcity, opportunity cost, comparative advantage
- Market equilibrium, elasticity, welfare analysis
- Market structures: competition, monopoly, oligopoly
- Market failure, externalities, public goods
- National accounts, growth, unemployment, inflation
- Monetary and fiscal policy instruments

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with tutorial (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-90 — Written examination, 90 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-90).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Mankiw, Taylor: Economics, Cengage

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Foundation for IB-3-011.

Module description IB-1-004 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-1-005 Academic and Business English

Semester	1	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Language Centre, Dr. Coralie Bendtsen

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: English at level B2 of the Common European Framework

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- write structured analytical texts appropriate to an academic business context
- conduct professional correspondence and meetings in English
- deliver and defend a structured business presentation

Module content [binding]

- Academic writing conventions and argument structure
- Business correspondence registers
- Meeting and negotiation language
- Presentation structure and delivery
- Referencing and source integration

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar-style language instruction (4 SWS) in groups of no more than 20

Form of assessment [binding]: PO — Portfolio

- Analytical essay (1,500 words) (40 %)
- Business correspondence file (25 %)
- Individual presentation (15 min) (35 %)

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Portfolio comprising the three components listed above. All components must be submitted; the aggregate must be passed.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Course materials provided by the Language Centre

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-1-005 — coordinator: Language Centre, Dr. Coralie Bendtsen, Language Centre.

Semester 2

This section contains 5 module descriptions.

IB-2-006 Management Accounting

Semester	2	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-1-002

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- allocate costs to cost centres and cost objects
- prepare contribution margin analyses for operational decisions
- design budgets and variance analyses

Module content [binding]

- Cost types, cost centres, cost objects
- Full costing and direct costing
- Contribution margin analysis and break-even
- Budgeting and variance analysis
- Transfer pricing in multinational groups
- Cost information for make-or-buy decisions

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with exercise (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-120 — Written examination, 120 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-120).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Drury: Management and Cost Accounting, Cengage

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-2-006 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-2-007 Marketing

Semester	2	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-1-001

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- analyse markets and derive segmentation and positioning decisions
- design a coherent marketing mix for a defined target group
- evaluate marketing measures against defined objectives

Module content [binding]

- Consumer behaviour and buying decision processes
- Market research: design, sampling, analysis
- Segmentation, targeting, positioning
- Product, price, distribution and communication policy
- Digital marketing channels and measurement
- Marketing controlling

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (2 SWS) and project work in teams (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PA — Project work

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Acceptance of the team marketing plan and its presentation. Individual contributions are separately assessed.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Kotler, Keller, Chernev: Marketing Management, Pearson

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Foundation for IB-4-017.

Module description IB-2-007 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-2-008 Business Law

Semester	2	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. iur. Bastian Kirchgässner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- identify the legal framework applicable to a commercial transaction
- assess the formation and performance of contracts under German civil law
- recognise the limits of their own legal assessment and the need for professional advice

Module content [binding]

- Sources of German private law; civil code structure
- Formation of contracts, defects of intent
- Sales law and warranty
- Commercial law: merchant status, commercial transactions
- Company law: partnerships and corporations
- Introduction to international sales law (CISG)

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with case analysis (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-120 — Written examination, 120 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-120).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Führich: Wirtschaftsprivatrecht, Vahlen
- Consolidated texts of the German Civil Code and Commercial Code

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

***Note:** Taught in English with reference to German legal sources. Statutory texts are used in the German original with English working translations.*

Module description IB-2-008 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. iur. Bastian Kirchgässner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-2-009 Data Analysis for Business

Semester	2	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-1-003

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- prepare and clean business data sets for analysis
- select and apply appropriate analytical methods to a business question
- communicate analytical findings to a non-technical audience

Module content [binding]

- Data sources and data quality in business contexts
- Spreadsheet and statistical software workflows
- Multiple regression and interpretation
- Time series and forecasting basics
- Classification methods for customer analytics
- Reporting and visualisation principles

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (2 SWS) and computer laboratory (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PA — Project work

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Acceptance of the analytical project report of 15 to 20 pages including reproducible analysis files.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system; laboratory equipment and experimental set-ups; computer workstations and specialist software

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Field: Discovering Statistics, Sage

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Foundation for IB-6-027.

Module description IB-2-009 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-2-010 Business German A1

Semester	2	LP	6	SWS	6
Workload	150 h (90 h contact, 60 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	German	Module coordinator	Language Centre, Dr. Coralie Bendtsen

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: No prior knowledge of German required

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- manage basic everyday and workplace exchanges in German
- read simple business correspondence with dictionary support
- describe their own professional background in simple terms

Module content [binding]

- Greetings, introductions, workplace roles
- Present tense; nominative and accusative
- Numbers, dates, appointments
- Simple business correspondence
- Telephone and reception situations

Teaching and learning methods: Language course (6 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PO — Portfolio

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Portfolio comprising a written test, an oral interaction task and a learning diary.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Course materials provided by the Language Centre

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Prerequisite for IB-3-015.

***Note:** Taught entirely in German. Higher contact time than other 6-credit modules (6 SWS) reflecting the requirements of beginner language instruction. Students with certified German at level A2 or above may apply to the examination board for recognition under § 18 APO.*

Module description IB-2-010 — coordinator: Language Centre, Dr. Coralie Bendtsen, Language Centre.

Semester 3

This section contains 5 module descriptions.

IB-3-011 International Trade and Finance

Semester	3	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-1-004

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- explain patterns of international trade using standard trade models
- assess the effect of trade policy instruments on firms and consumers
- manage foreign exchange exposure in a commercial setting

Module content [binding]

- Comparative advantage and factor endowment models
- Trade policy: tariffs, quotas, non-tariff barriers
- Regional integration and the internal market
- Balance of payments
- Exchange rate regimes and determination
- Instruments for hedging currency exposure

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with tutorial (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-120 — Written examination, 120 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-120).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Krugman, Obstfeld, Melitz: International Economics, Pearson

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-3-011 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-3-012 Human Resource Management

Semester	3	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-1-001

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- design recruitment and selection processes that meet legal requirements
- evaluate development and remuneration instruments
- assess the role of employee representation in German enterprises

Module content [binding]

- Personnel planning and recruitment
- Selection instruments and their validity
- Performance management and development
- Remuneration systems
- Employment law essentials and co-determination
- Diversity and inclusion in the workplace

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar (2 SWS) with case work (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: Pr — Presentation

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Presentation of approximately 30 minutes with written handout.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Armstrong, Taylor: Armstrong's Handbook of Human Resource Management Practice, Kogan Page

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-3-012 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-3-013 Operations and Supply Chain Management

Semester	3	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-1-003

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- design production and distribution processes against cost and service targets
- apply inventory models to procurement decisions
- assess supply chain risk and resilience measures

Module content [binding]

- Process types and capacity planning
- Inventory models and replenishment policies
- Production planning and control
- Supplier selection and evaluation
- Logistics networks and distribution
- Supply chain risk and sustainability

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with exercise (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-90 — Written examination, 90 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-90).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Slack, Brandon-Jones: Operations Management, Pearson

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-3-013 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-3-014 Corporate Finance

Semester	3	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-1-002

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-1-003

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- appraise investment projects using discounted cash flow methods
- assess financing alternatives and their cost
- analyse financial statements for credit and investment decisions

Module content [binding]

- Time value of money, net present value, internal rate of return
- Cost of capital and capital structure
- Equity and debt financing instruments
- Working capital management
- Financial statement analysis and ratios
- Introduction to company valuation

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with exercise (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-120 — Written examination, 120 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-120).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Brealey, Myers, Allen: Principles of Corporate Finance, McGraw-Hill

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-3-014 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-3-015 Business German A2

Semester	3	LP	6	SWS	6
Workload	150 h (90 h contact, 60 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	German	Module coordinator	Language Centre, Dr. Coralie Bendtsen

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-2-010 or certified German at level A1

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- handle routine workplace communication in German
- write short business letters and e-mails
- understand the main points of simple German business texts

Module content [binding]

- Perfect and preterite tenses; dative case
- Subordinate clauses and connectors
- Business correspondence: enquiry, offer, order, complaint
- Workplace vocabulary across business functions
- Short presentations in German

Teaching and learning methods: Language course (6 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PO — Portfolio

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Portfolio comprising a written test, an oral interaction task and a written correspondence file.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Course materials provided by the Language Centre

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Recommended preparation for a German-speaking placement in IB-5-020.

Note: Taught entirely in German. Higher contact time (6 SWS) than other 6-credit modules.

Module description IB-3-015 — coordinator: Language Centre, Dr. Coralie Bendtsen, Language Centre.

Semester 4

This section contains 4 module descriptions.

IB-4-016 Strategic Management

Semester	4	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-1-001

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-3-014

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- conduct structured industry and resource analyses
- formulate and justify competitive strategies
- assess the feasibility of strategic options against organisational capabilities

Module content [binding]

- Strategic analysis: industry structure, resources, capabilities
- Generic and hybrid competitive strategies
- Corporate strategy: diversification, vertical integration
- Internationalisation strategies and entry modes
- Strategy implementation and control
- Strategic change management

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar (2 SWS) with case study work (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: HA — Term paper

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Term paper of 20 to 25 pages analysing an assigned company case.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Grant: Contemporary Strategy Analysis, Wiley

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-4-016 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-4-017 International Marketing

Semester	4	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-2-007

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- evaluate the standardisation-adaptation trade-off across markets
- design market entry strategies for a defined product
- assess cultural influences on marketing communication

Module content [binding]

- International market selection and screening
- Entry modes: export, licensing, joint venture, subsidiary
- Standardisation versus adaptation of the marketing mix
- International pricing and grey markets
- Cross-cultural communication in advertising
- International brand management

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (2 SWS) and project work (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PA — Project work

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Acceptance of the market entry plan and its presentation.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Hollensen: Global Marketing, Pearson

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-4-017 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-4-018 Cross-Cultural Management

Semester	4	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- apply cultural dimension frameworks critically to management situations
- anticipate sources of misunderstanding in international teams
- design integration measures for cross-border cooperation

Module content [binding]

- Concepts of culture and cultural dimension models
- Critique of dimension-based approaches
- Communication styles and negotiation across cultures
- Leadership expectations in different contexts
- Expatriate assignment and repatriation
- Preparation for the semester abroad

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar (2 SWS) with simulation exercises (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: Pr — Presentation

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Presentation of approximately 25 minutes with written handout of 5 to 8 pages.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Thomas, Peterson: Cross-Cultural Management, Sage

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Prepares the semester abroad (IB-5-020).

Module description IB-4-018 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-4-019 Business Ethics and Sustainability

Semester	4	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. iur. Bastian Kirchgässner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- analyse business decisions using established ethical frameworks
- assess corporate sustainability reporting against regulatory requirements
- evaluate supply chain due diligence obligations

Module content [binding]

- Normative ethical frameworks applied to business
- Corporate social responsibility concepts
- Sustainability reporting standards and assurance
- Supply chain due diligence obligations
- Whistleblowing and compliance systems
- Case analysis of corporate misconduct

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar (3 SWS) with case discussion (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: HA — Term paper

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Term paper of 15 to 20 pages.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Crane, Matten: Business Ethics, Oxford University Press

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-4-019 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. iur. Bastian Kirchgässner, Department of Business Studies.

Semester 5

This section contains 2 module descriptions.

IB-5-020 Study Abroad Semester

Semester	5	LP	24	SWS	0
Workload	600 h (0 h contact, 600 h self-study)	Frequency	Every semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	Depends on host institution	Module coordinator	International Office, Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: Evidence of at least 100 credit points and a learning agreement approved before departure

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-4-018

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- study successfully within a different academic system
- reflect on their own cultural assumptions in an unfamiliar environment
- operate independently in an international academic and social context

Module content [binding]

- Study at a partner institution abroad for one semester
- Modules agreed in advance in a learning agreement
- Minimum of 24 credit points or the equivalent workload at the host institution

Teaching and learning methods: Study at a partner institution with supervision by the International Office

Form of assessment [binding]: LN — Ungraded; pass/fail

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Transcript of records from the host institution evidencing the agreed workload, and recognition by the examination board under the Ordinance on the Recognition of Achievements Obtained Abroad. Assessed as passed or not passed.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Determined by the host institution

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Note: Assessed as pass/fail and excluded from the overall grade under § 9 of the Programme-Specific Provisions, deviating from § 13 APO. Unusual workload structure: 600 hours with no contact time at Rheinmark.

Module description IB-5-020 — coordinator: International Office, Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-5-021 Intercultural Preparation and Reflection

Semester	5	LP	6	SWS	2
Workload	150 h (30 h contact, 120 h self-study)	Frequency	Every semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: Concurrent or prior completion of IB-5-020

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-4-018

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- prepare systematically for study in an unfamiliar academic culture
- document and analyse intercultural critical incidents
- articulate the professional value of the experience abroad

Module content [binding]

- Pre-departure briefing: academic system, administration, safety
- Critical incident technique
- Structured reflection methods
- Return workshop and peer exchange

Teaching and learning methods: Block seminars before departure and after return (2 SWS in total)

Form of assessment [binding]: PO — Portfolio

- Pre-departure preparation dossier (30 %)
- Reflective journal during the stay abroad (40 %)
- Return presentation (30 %)

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Portfolio comprising the three components listed above.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Course materials provided by the International Office

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Note: Delivered in block format before departure and after return. Unusual workload structure: 150 hours against only 2 SWS of contact time.

Module description IB-5-021 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

Semester 6

This section contains 3 module descriptions.

IB-6-022 International Business Project

Semester	6	LP	9	SWS	4
Workload	225 h (60 h contact, 165 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-5-020

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-4-016, IB-4-017

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- deliver a consulting-style analysis for an external client
- manage a project team under time and information constraints
- present recommendations to a client audience

Module content [binding]

- Project definition with an external partner organisation
- Structured problem solving and hypothesis-driven analysis
- Data collection and stakeholder interviews
- Recommendation development and cost assessment
- Client presentation and handover

Teaching and learning methods: Supervised project work in teams of four to six (4 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PA — Project work

- Written project report (60 %)
- Client presentation (25 %)
- Individual reflection paper (15 %)

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Acceptance of all three components. The individual reflection paper must be passed independently.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Minto: The Pyramid Principle, Pearson

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-6-022 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-6-023 Bachelor's Thesis

Semester	6	LP	12	SWS	0
Workload	300 h (0 h contact, 300 h self-study)	Frequency	Every semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Chair of the examination board

Formal prerequisites: See special note; the two binding sources disagree

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-6-022

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- treat a business question independently using scientific methods
- situate the analysis within the relevant literature
- present findings in a structured written form

Module content [binding]

- Independent treatment of a topic from international business
- Topic agreed with a supervising examiner and registered with the examination board

Teaching and learning methods: Independent work under supervision

Form of assessment [binding]: BA — Bachelor's thesis; processing time three months

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Submission within the processing period and assessment as at least sufficient (4.0).

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Topic-specific

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business.

***Note:** Registration threshold: § 14 Abs. 2 of the Programme-Specific Provisions states 120 credit points; footnote 4 to Annex 1 states 150 credit points. Documented conflict K-01.*

Module description IB-6-023 — coordinator: Chair of the examination board, Department of Business Studies.

IB-6-024 Colloquium

Semester	6	LP	3	SWS	0
Workload	75 h (0 h contact, 75 h self-study)	Frequency	Every semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Compulsory	Language	English	Module coordinator	Chair of the examination board

Formal prerequisites: Bachelor's thesis (IB-6-023) assessed as at least sufficient

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- present and defend the findings of the bachelor's thesis
- justify methodological choices in discussion

Module content [binding]

- Presentation of approximately 15 minutes
- Academic discussion of approximately 15 minutes

Teaching and learning methods: Oral examination before two examiners under § 22 APO

Form of assessment [binding]: Ko — Colloquium, 30 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the colloquium.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- None

Usability: Compulsory module of the B.A. International Business. Concludes the programme.

Module description IB-6-024 — coordinator: Chair of the examination board, Department of Business Studies.

Elective catalogue

This section contains 4 module descriptions.

IB-4-025 Digital Business Models

Semester	4	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Elective	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-1-001

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- analyse platform and subscription business models
- assess network effects and their strategic consequences

Module content [binding]

- Business model frameworks
- Platform economics and network effects
- Subscription and usage-based pricing
- Digital transformation of incumbents
- Data as a strategic resource

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar (2 SWS) with project work (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PA — Project work

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Acceptance of the business model analysis and its presentation.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Osterwalder, Pigneur: Business Model Generation, Wiley

Usability: Elective module of the B.A. International Business, elective catalogue under Annex 2 of the Programme-Specific Provisions.

Module description IB-4-025 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Nadja Lippert, Department of Business Studies.

IB-4-026 Entrepreneurship and Start-up Management

Semester	4	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Elective	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-3-014

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- develop and test a venture concept
- prepare a financing plan for an early-stage venture

Module content [binding]

- Opportunity recognition and validation
- Lean start-up methods
- Financial planning for new ventures
- Financing sources and investor expectations
- Legal form and founding formalities in Germany

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar (2 SWS) with venture project (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: Pr — Presentation

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Pitch presentation of approximately 20 minutes with written venture concept.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Blank, Dorf: The Startup Owner's Manual, Wiley

Usability: Elective module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-4-026 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-6-027 Business Analytics and Visualisation

Semester	6	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Elective	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner

Formal prerequisites: Successful completion of IB-2-009

Recommended prior knowledge: None

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- build analytical dashboards for management reporting
- select visual encodings appropriate to the analytical question

Module content [binding]

- Analytical workflow from question to decision
- Dashboard design principles
- Predictive models in a reporting context
- Data governance and reporting integrity

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (2 SWS) and computer laboratory (2 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PA — Project work

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Acceptance of the dashboard project and accompanying documentation.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system; laboratory equipment and experimental set-ups; computer workstations and specialist software

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Few: Information Dashboard Design, Analytics Press

Usability: Elective module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-6-027 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Emmerich Kaltenbrunner, Department of Business Studies.

IB-6-028 Negotiation and Conflict Management

Semester	6	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, summer semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Elective	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-4-018

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- prepare and conduct integrative negotiations
- analyse conflict dynamics in organisational settings

Module content [binding]

- Distributive and integrative negotiation
- Preparation frameworks and BATNA analysis
- Negotiation across cultures
- Conflict diagnosis and intervention
- Mediation basics

Teaching and learning methods: Seminar with negotiation simulations (4 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: PO — Portfolio

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Portfolio comprising negotiation preparation documents, a recorded simulation and a reflection paper.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Fisher, Ury, Patton: Getting to Yes, Penguin

Usability: Elective module of the B.A. International Business.

Module description IB-6-028 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. Ruth Aschenbrenner, Department of Business Studies.

Additional modules

This section contains 1 module description.

IB-5-029 International Taxation

Semester	5	LP	6	SWS	4
Workload	150 h (60 h contact, 90 h self-study)	Frequency	Annually, winter semester	Duration	1 semester
Module type	Additional module (Zusatzmodul)	Language	English	Module coordinator	Prof. Dr. iur. Bastian Kirchgässner

Formal prerequisites: None

Recommended prior knowledge: IB-2-008

Learning outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students are able to

- identify the tax consequences of cross-border business activity
- apply double taxation agreements to simple fact patterns

Module content [binding]

- Principles of international tax law
- Residence and source taxation
- Double taxation agreements and relief methods
- Transfer pricing fundamentals
- Permanent establishment concepts

Teaching and learning methods: Lecture (3 SWS) with case exercises (1 SWS)

Form of assessment [binding]: KI-90 — Written examination, 90 minutes

Requirements for the award of credit points [binding]: Passing the written examination (KI-90). Credits are recorded as additional credits under § 12 of the Programme-Specific Provisions and do not enter the overall grade.

Media: Board and presentation slides; teaching materials provided electronically via the university learning management system

Admission requirement: No requirements beyond registration for the examination.

Literature:

- Brähler: Internationales Steuerrecht, Springer Gabler

Usability: Additional module of the B.A. International Business. Not part of the elective catalogue in Annex 2.

Module description IB-5-029 — coordinator: Prof. Dr. iur. Bastian Kirchgässner, Department of Business Studies.